

Dual-Track Lesson Design ELD Amplification · Grades 11–12

About This Resource: This paired lesson was designed to amplify a core ELA unit on editorial cartoons for multilingual learners alongside their native English-speaking peers. The student edition and teacher edition work together. One gives students the scaffolded language and tasks they need to access the content, and the other gives teachers the instructional logic behind every design decision. Neither document works without the other.

Three-level differentiation: The lesson is differentiated across three WIDA proficiency bands Substantial/Emerging, Moderate/Expanding, and Minimal/Bridging with distinct tasks, sentence frames, and discussion prompts at each level. A single task with optional supports treats differentiation as an afterthought. Building three distinct entry points into the lesson structure treats it as a design requirement.

Language as the focus, not a barrier: The Explore Language section teaches students the precise academic language needed to analyze editorial cartoons before asking them to use it. Sentence frames are embedded directly into the analysis tasks so students practice the language in context rather than in isolation. Cognate support for Spanish speakers is included at the point of instruction, not in a separate glossary.

Teacher edition as instructional design documentation: The teacher edition makes the reasoning behind every instructional choice visible — what to model, what questions to ask at each proficiency level, how to determine when a student is ready to progress, and what additional practice looks like when they are not. It is designed to be used during lesson planning and in the moment.

Formatting and client specifications: Both documents were formatted to meet the client's publishing requirements, including a defined heading hierarchy.

[A Head (H1)] Activity 3.13 Interacting in Meaningful Ways: Reading Editorial Cartoons

[LT C Head (H3)] Learning Targets

- I can explain how editorial cartoons communicate opinions through visual and language choices.
- I can contribute relevant ideas and questions during collaborative discussions.

Crosswalk[California ELD Standards] ELD.PI.11-12.1, ELD.PI.11-12.6a

[B Head (H2)] Preview

In this activity, you will analyze visual and language choices in editorial cartoons and discuss how they communicate opinions and perspectives.

[B Head (H2)] Preview–View–Review

With a partner, think about what the outside of your school looks like in your preferred language.

Look at a photograph of your school. Pay attention to key details about the building.

With a partner, discuss:

- What makes this building look different from others?
- If someone were to illustrate the school as a cartoon, what two details would they need to draw?
- How would the drawing change if someone had a positive or negative view of the school?

Be prepared to share.

What you discussed relates to how cartoonists emphasize a few details to illustrate something real and express opinions visually.

[B Head (H2)] Explore Language: Analyzing Opinions in Editorial Cartoons

Editorial cartoons are more than visual representations of real things. They communicate opinions and perspectives (*perspectiva*, Spanish) mostly through visual

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[A Head (H1)] Activity 3.13 Interacting in Meaningful Ways: Reading Editorial Cartoons

[C Head (H3)] Plan

Materials: A picture of your school

Suggested Pacing: 1 50-minute class period – connects with ELA 3.13

California ELD Standards:

ELD.PI.11-12.6a Reading/viewing closely

ELD.PI.11-12.1 Exchanging information/ideas

Language Objectives:

- Analyze how visual symbols, captions, and rhetorical techniques communicate perspectives in editorial cartoons during collaborative discussions.

[B Head (H2)] Content Bridge

In *Soar!* Activity 3.13, students analyze and create their own editorial cartoon. ELD students will analyze how editorial cartoons convey meaning through visual and language choices.

[B Head (H2)] Direct Instruction

[align with Preview] **1** Read aloud the Learning Targets. Then have students perform a choral reading.

[align with SE Preview–View–Review] **2** Direct partners to think about what their school looks like outside using their preferred language before showing a picture. Encourage partners to discuss the school’s distinguishing features before they share with the class. Tell students that cartoonists adapt distinguishing features of real people, places, and things to convey a message.

[align with SE Explore Language] **3** Explain that editorial cartoons communicate opinions and perspectives through their drawings and visuals. Highlight the cognate *perspectiva* (Spanish/Portuguese) to support understanding. Explain that artists use distortion, exaggeration, symbolism, captions and emotions to help convey their intended message in cartoons.

4 Model how to identify the artist’s message using examples:

- Distortion: a politician is drawn with a huge mouth. Ask: *What appears unrealistic?*

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details. Readers can analyze the artist’s intended message in editorial cartoons by asking:

- Distortion: What appears unusually large or small? Does that make the object or person more or less favorable?
- Exaggeration: What details are unrealistic?
- Symbolism: What symbols stand out? What are they associated with?
- Captions: If there are captions, do they contradict what is happening?
- Emotion: What emotion does the image create?

To explain the messages within editorial cartoons when speaking or writing, use language like:

To...	Use Language Like...
Identify the exaggeration	The artist exaggerates...
Explain what it represents	It represents... It suggests...
Explain the opinion	The artist’s opinion is shown through...
Analyze the effect on the audience	The exaggerated image makes viewers feel...

[Substantial – Emerging icon]

With a partner, read the editorial cartoon description. Underline the exaggerated visual details and discuss the message.

A cartoon shows a snake severed into 13 parts. Each piece of the snake is labeled with the name of one of the American colonies. The caption reads, "Divided we die."

Discuss:

- What details are unrealistic or exaggerated?
- What symbols stand out? What are they associated with?
- What emotion does the image create?

Use the sentence frame to explain the meaning:
The cartoon suggests that [WOL]. This makes viewers feel [WOL].

- Exaggeration: a parent is buried under dishes. Ask: *What detail is exaggerated?* Explain that the artist may criticize the amount of chores parents complete.
- Symbolism: Earth melts like an ice cream cone. Ask: *What symbol stands out?* Explain that the symbol is Earth. Since the symbol is melting it suggests concern about environmental destruction.

5 Explain how editorial cartoons can be described using precise language. Model with an example: *The artist distorts a huge mouth to represent their lies. It suggests politicians don’t always say exactly what they mean.* If needed model again: *The artist exaggerates the amount of dishes. This exaggerated image makes viewers feel sad for parents who feel buried under the weight of housework.*

6 Have partners orally practice explaining the meaning behind the symbolism of the third example, using sentence frames from the table.

[B Head (H2)] Differentiate

[C Head (H3)] Substantial – Emerging Remind students that exaggerated visual details convey a message in editorial cartoons. Explain that these small visual details can change the interpretation of the editorial cartoon. As needed, ask: <i>What visual details are exaggerated? How does this make the viewers feel?</i> If students are able to ☐ identify exaggerated visual details that communicate an opinion ELD.PI.11-12.6aEm ☐ orally share simple interpretations about the cartoon’s message ELD.PI.11-12.1Em then have them progress on to the next level. Sample Response: Political cartoons use big, exaggerated images to share opinions. The images show what the artist thinks about powerful people or groups.	[C Head (H3)] Additional Practice • Display this description: “A student drags a backpack larger than their body.” Have students draw the exaggerated detail and explain what opinion the artist is communicating. Then, students orally explain how the image influences viewers.
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On your own, plan an editorial cartoon that uses visual details and captions to communicate the message that students spend too much time on their phones. Then explain how you used details to share this perspective. [WOL]
[Moderate – Expanding icon] With a partner, read the editorial cartoon description. Underline the visual details and explain how they communicate the artist’s opinion. Add a caption to strengthen the message. Description: A student sits at a desk buried under a huge pile of standardized tests labeled “Your Future.” Discuss: • What details are unrealistic or exaggerated? • What emotion do the visual details create? • How does the caption strengthen the message? Explain how the visual details and caption communicate the artist’s perspective. [WOL] On your own, plan an editorial cartoon that uses visual details and captions to communicate the message that students spend too much time on their phones. Then explain how you used details to share this perspective. [WOL]
[Minimal – Bridging icon] With a partner, create a description of an editorial cartoon that communicates the message: “Earth is dying and people must take action.” Include distorted, exaggerated, and symbolic visual details and a caption that strengthen the opinion. Discuss: • How do you want readers to feel when they read it? • How do the visuals and captions strengthen the message? Explain how the visual details and caption influence viewers’ understanding of the issue. [WOL]

If not, then provide students with additional practice at this level.	
[C Head (H3)] Moderate – Expanding Remind students that editorial cartoons express the artist’s opinion by understanding the visual details of the image. As needed, ask: <i>What is ironic about the cartoon’s description? What details help you understand the artist’s opinion? How would the cartoon’s message change if the caption was different?</i> If students are able to ❑ explain how visual details and captions communicate the artist’s opinion ELD.PI.11-12.6aEx ❑ orally explain interpretations using relevant details ELD.PI.11-12.1Ex then have them progress on to the next level. Sample Response: By depicting a student physically overwhelmed by tests, the artist emphasizes the relationship between school pressure and individual identity. I think the message is arguing that the education system has reduced students to their test scores. If not, then provide students with additional practice at this level.	[C Head (H3)] Additional Practice • Display this cartoon description: “A student sits under a mountain of homework labeled ‘Weekend Plans.’” Have students write two captions that create different messages about homework. Then, students explain how each caption changes the audience’s interpretation.
[C Head (H3)] Minimal – Bridging Remind students that editorial cartoons use symbolism, exaggeration, and visual details to communicate opinions indirectly. Ask: <i>Which details most strongly communicate the message? How do these details influence the audience’s interpretation?</i> If students are able to	[C Head (H3)] Additional Practice • Display two editorial cartoon descriptions about the same issue with different captions and exaggerated details. Have students discuss which cartoon communicates the stronger opinion and explain how the visuals

On your own, plan an editorial cartoon that uses visual details and captions to communicate the message that students spend too much time on their phones. Then explain how you used details to share this perspective.

[WOL]

[B Head (H2)] ELPAC Practice: Read a Short Informational Passage

Read the short passage. Then, answer the multiple-choice questions about the text.

Flint Water Crisis

1 In 2014, Flint, Michigan underwent a water crisis due to the presence of contaminated water within their city's infrastructure. There was a lack of adequate testing and safety regulations when the city switched its main water source. After the change, many people noticed the unsanitary appearance of the water. Furthermore, many developed health issues including rashes, hair loss, and itchy skin. After dismissing numerous concerns about the quality of the water, later examinations revealed high levels of lead and bacteria in the water. Increased amounts of lead were detected in many children's blood levels. Lead contamination can create various health issues including kidney disease, fertility issues, and brain development.

2 To combat the issue, many community members became vocal about the importance of establishing better water regulations. Citizens also wanted the city to provide adequate drinking water among all Flint residents as the city replaced all lead water pipes. After various legal battles, the court system sided with the residents, which led to the creation of water delivery centers for all Flint residents as well as an established maintenance program for water filtering.

- The author of the selection presented the information using -
 - a. sequencing
 - b. problem and solution
 - c. compare and contrast
 - d. main idea

2. Which sentence best supports the idea that the water crises could have been prevented?

- “To combat the issue, many community members became vocal about the importance of establishing better water regulations.”

- ❑ analyze how symbolic and exaggerated details shape the cartoon's message
ELD.PI.11-12.6aBr
- ❑ orally justify interpretations using evidence-based language
ELD.PI.11-12.1Br

then have them extend their learning.

Sample Response: I drew a dying Earth trapped inside a countdown no one is stopping, to showcase the relationship between human awareness and human responsibility. I think the message is arguing that knowing about the climate crisis without acting on that knowledge is itself a form of destruction

If not, then provide students with additional practice at this level.

influence the audience.
Then, students revise one
caption to strengthen the
message.

[C Head (H3)] Extend

For students who may benefit from extended practice, show students an editorial cartoon. Have students describe the visual using distorted, exaggerated, or symbolic details and add a caption to convey a message. Then, have students switch with a partner to interpret the cartoon's message and explain which details most clearly communicate the artist's opinion

[B Head (H2)] Language Link

In addition to the instruction and practice activities, you can support MLL students by

- prompting students to explain their reasoning with questions (*Why do you think that?*);
- modeling how to respond to their peers by agreeing, disagreeing, and building on others' opinions;
- providing multiple visual examples of successful editorial cartoons to inspire creativity and encourage unique ideation.

- “In 2014, Flint, Michigan underwent a water crisis due to the presence of contaminated water within their city’s infrastructure.”
- “There was a lack of adequate testing and safety regulations when the city switched its main water source.”
- “Citizens also wanted the city to provide adequate drinking water among all Flint residents as the city replaced all lead water pipes.”

3. Based on the text, we can infer that the Flint residents..

- have developed a stronger immune system.
- are determined to keep government officials accountable with yearly water testing.
- developed a disgust for water.
- are in favor of the development of newer road infrastructures within the city.